

Highway Transitway Corridor Study

March 14, 2013

Highway 169 Coalition



Twin Cities Transportation Planning

Transportation Policy Plan (TPP)

- Highway planning
 - Managed lanes
 - Bus shoulders
- Transit planning
 - Park-and-ride Plan
 - Transitway corridors
 - Bus system planning

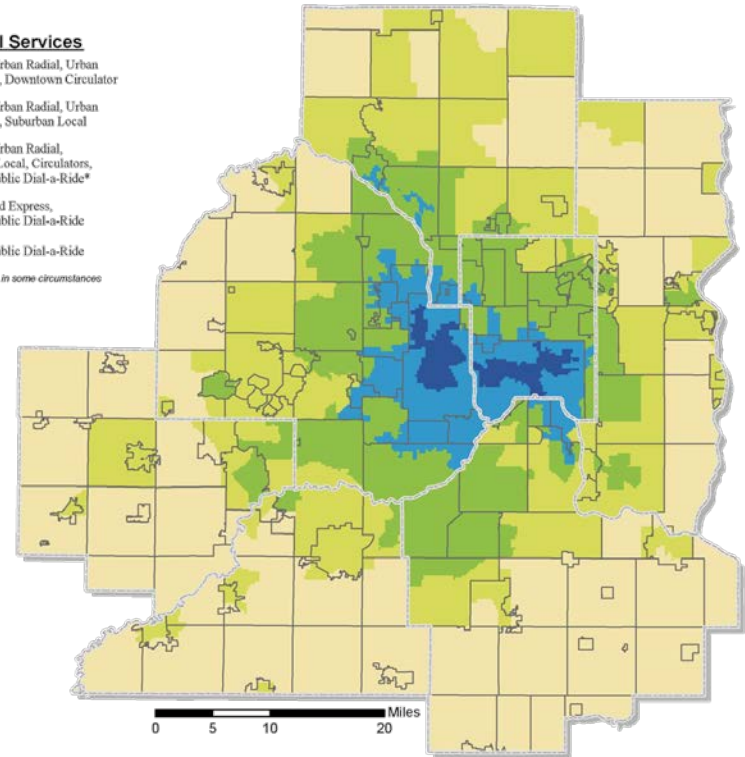
Market Area	Typical Services
Area 1	Express, Urban Radial, Urban Crosstown, Downtown Circulator
Area 2	Express, Urban Radial, Urban Crosstown, Suburban Local
Area 3	Express, Urban Radial, Suburban Local, Circulators, General Public Dial-a-Ride*
Area 4	Peak Period Express, General Public Dial-a-Ride
Area 5	General Public Dial-a-Ride

*Market Area 3 Dial-a-Ride is appropriate in some circumstances

- ADA paratransit service follows federal and state regulations in the regular route service area

- Additional details on market areas and service standards are available in **Appendix G**

- Market area geography was calculated at the census block group level.



Transit Service Flexibility

Transit Service Types

- Local bus: frequent and serving many trip patterns and types
- Express bus: mostly peak hour service serving trips to major metro centers
- Transitways: high-capacity service or highest-demand corridors
- Dial-a-ride: minimum level of service where overall demand is limited

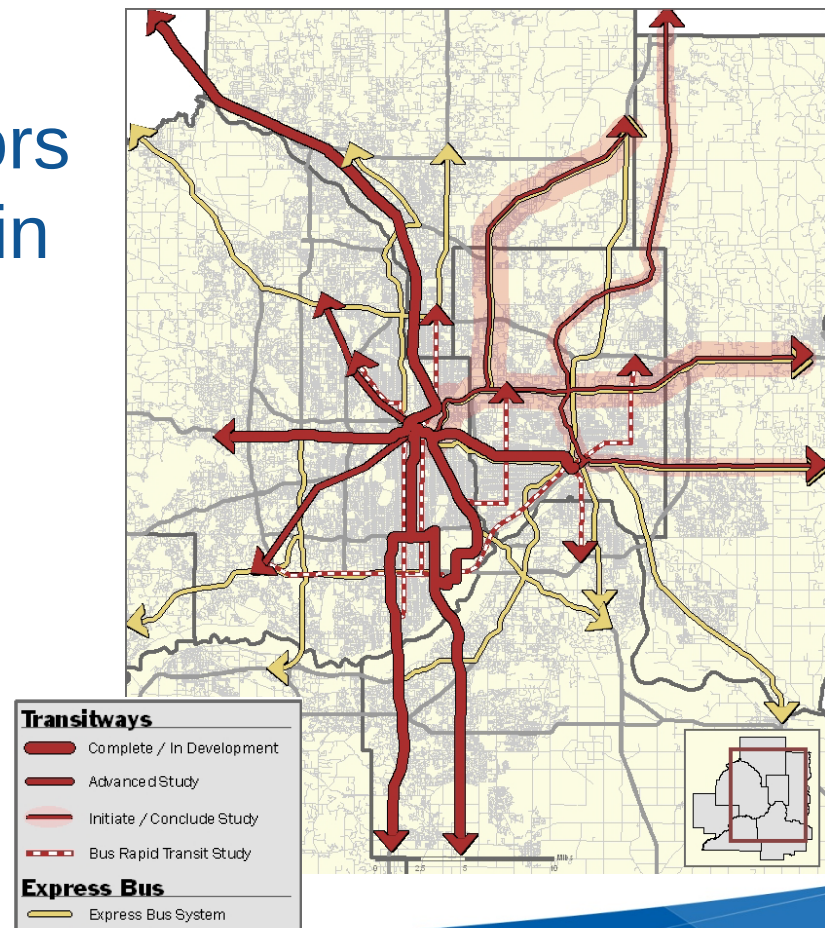
Background – Transit Master Study

- Studied regional transit corridors for investment in light rail or dedicated busway
- Some corridors also studied for commuter rail
- Highway 169 illustrated moderate demand but high costs for dedicated busway



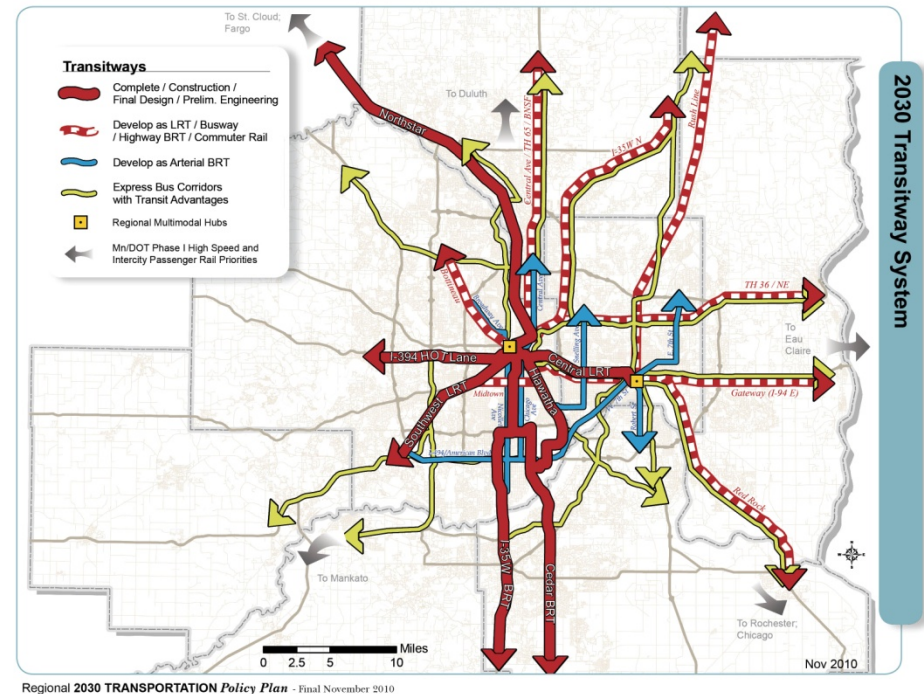
Background – Transit Master Study

- Acknowledged corridors already completed or in development
- Identified potential future corridors for study



Transportation Policy Plan (TPP)

- Transitway modes on highways:
 - Highway bus rapid transit (BRT)
 - Express bus corridors with Transit Advantages
- Synergy between highway and transit investments



Transportation Policy Plan (TPP)

- Highway transit advantages:
 - Bus-only shoulders
 - Managed lanes
- Regional experience:
 - I-35 W South BRT
 - Cedar BRT



Project Purpose

- 8 corridors for concept plan development

Hwy 212/ 5

Hwy 169

I-394

I-94 West

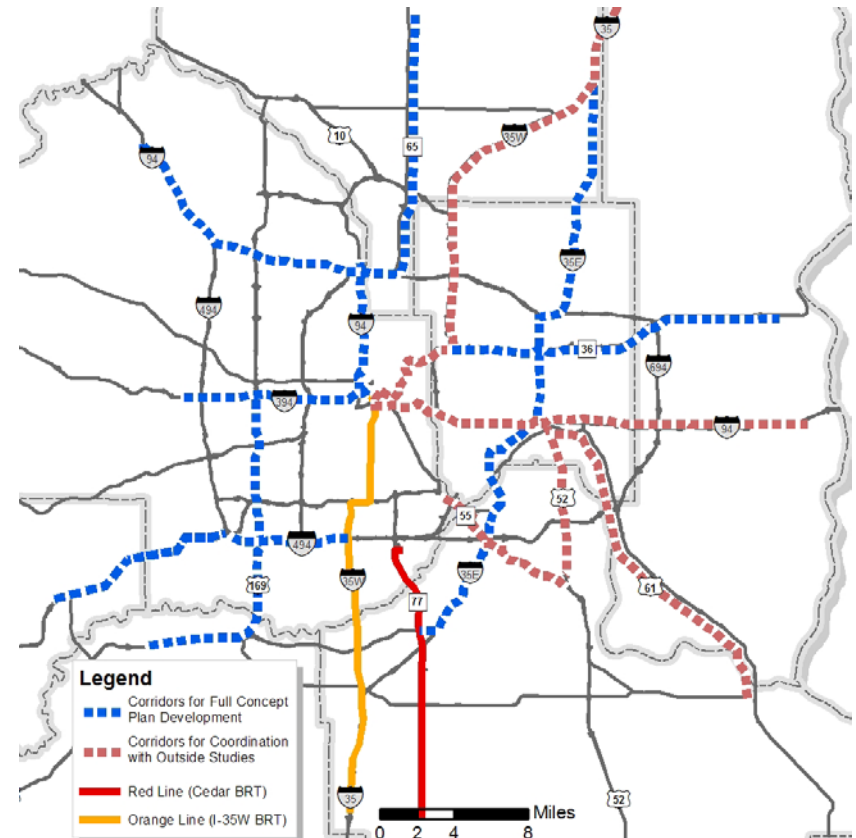
Hwy 65

Hwy 36

I-35 E North

I-35 E South

- Additional corridors already under study will coordinate with this study



Project Purpose

- *Market Analysis:* Determine transit demand for all-day vs. peak-only service
- *Long-Range Planning:* Better understand highway BRT demand in the region and range of costs and benefits
- *Corridor Planning:* Include analysis in future transit and highway studies

Project Phases

- Phase 1: Finalize work plan (complete)
- Phase 2: Existing markets and conditions
 - Transportation system conditions
 - Demographics, centers, and land use
 - Transit barriers (physical or geographic)

Project Phases

- Phase 3: Future markets and conditions
 - Planned demographics (existing forecasts)
 - Planned land use (existing comp plans)
 - Planned transportation improvements
 - Transit plans
 - Highway plans (coordination with MnDOT and local communities)
 - Define market areas

Project Phases

- Phase 4: Corridor improvement plan development
 - Investment criteria for future transit service
 - High-level concept plans for each corridor
 - Extent of potential all-day service
 - Station locations and types
 - Other amenities

Project Phases

- Phase 5: Corridor evaluation
 - Screen corridor plans for benefits, integration with system plans, high-level cost estimates
 - Recommendations for potential improvements in corridors or opportunities for further study

Stakeholder Outreach

- Project Management Team
 - Metro Transit, MnDOT, Counties, Suburban providers
- Technical Advisory Group(s)
- Policy Stakeholder Group
 - Likely will be structured in workshop format
 - Many corridors have existing corridor groups

First Steps

- SRF Consulting under contract through 2013
 - Outreach Plan
 - Document existing and planned conditions
 - Develop transit service market areas for Highway BRT

Questions?

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